

Distinct Character Framework Glossary

FOUNDATION REFERENCE

Core language for protocol navigation, resource use, and practitioner alignment

Asset ID: DC-R03-GLO | Revision v0.1

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How to Use This Glossary

This glossary standardizes the language used across the Distinct Character protocol ecosystem. It is designed to support client comprehension, practitioner alignment, portal tagging, and future licensing consistency.

Terms are defined for educational use inside the Distinct Character framework. They are not diagnostic categories, clinical labels, legal definitions, or medical instructions.

Framework Terms

Term	Distinct Character Definition
12 Dimensions of Wellness	Distinct Character's expanded wellness model that adds Nervous System, Identity, Boundaries, and Self-Efficacy to the traditional eight dimensions.
Activation	A mobilized nervous-system state associated with urgency, tension, vigilance, fast speech, defensive posture, or action pressure.
Allostatic Cost	The physiological cost of adapting repeatedly to stress, demand, uncertainty, relational pressure, or environmental load.
Authority	The capacity to communicate, choose, decide, and lead from grounded internal command rather than urgency, appeasement, or performance.
Baseline	The current operating condition of the body, behavior, environment, and identity before idealization or performance is added.
Behavioral Governance	The structured practice of designing behavior through state awareness, decision rules, capacity protection, and repeatable systems.
Biological Infrastructure	The foundation of sleep, digestion, movement, recovery, sensory input, and regulation that supports identity, execution, and self-mastery.
Body Signal	A physical cue that provides information about state, load, threat, depletion, boundary pressure, or recovery need.
Capacity	The amount of physiological, cognitive, emotional, and relational demand a person can meet without moving into unsustainable debt.
Co-Regulation	Regulatory support that occurs through safe relational contact, voice, presence, attunement, rhythm, or shared environment.
Commercial Incubation	The Enterprise IP Mastermind layer where self-mastery, authority, and framework intelligence are converted into protected commercial architecture.
Dorsal Shutdown	A low-mobilization protective state associated with heaviness, numbness, withdrawal, collapse, fog, or reduced initiation.
Environmental Friction	A condition in the physical, relational, digital, financial, or operational environment that repeatedly increases load or dysregulation.
Execution Architecture	The system of capacity-aware decision rules, friction reduction, action loops, and recovery boundaries that makes action sustainable.

Term	Distinct Character Definition
Fawn Pattern	A relational survival pattern involving appeasement, over-accommodation, self-erasure, or compliance to preserve safety or belonging.
Functional Freeze	A high-output dysregulated state where performance continues while flexibility, felt presence, and recovery decline.
Governance Log	A recurring record used to observe state, decisions, behavior, capacity, and recovery patterns over time.
Identity Architecture	The internal structure of self-concept, standards, roles, meanings, patterns, and chosen operating principles.
Integration	The process of turning insight into behavior, rhythm, structure, and repeatable action under real conditions.
Interoception	The capacity to notice internal bodily signals such as breath, tension, hunger, pain, temperature, fatigue, and arousal.
Masking Economy	The hidden exchange system through which adaptation, concealment, presentation, and social calibration spend capacity to preserve safety, access, or acceptance.
Narrative Control	The governance of interpretation, meaning-making, inherited standards, distortion patterns, and identity-level conclusions.
Neuroception	A Polyvagal-informed term for the proposed pre-conscious evaluation of safety and threat cues.
Nervous System Governance	The ongoing practice of understanding state, monitoring load, adjusting inputs, and designing recovery so regulation becomes infrastructure.
Protocol	A structured operating sequence designed to move a user through assessment, practice, tracking, reflection, and integration.
Relational Command	The ability to communicate with clarity, boundaries, warmth, and authority without collapsing into urgency, control, or appeasement.
Recovery Debt	Accumulated depletion created when demand exceeds restoration over time.
Regulation	A state shift that increases access to clarity, choice, flexibility, social engagement, or recovery.
Self-Efficacy	The belief, grounded in evidence and repetition, that one's actions can influence outcomes and conditions.
Self-Mastery	The governed integration of identity, biology, emotion, behavior, environment, relationships, and purpose.
Signal Calibration	The practice of interpreting body signals with context, evidence, safety awareness, and appropriate professional support when needed.
Somatic Baseline	The body's starting regulation condition and stress pattern before deeper identity, execution, relational, or capstone work proceeds.

Term	Distinct Character Definition
Soft Power	Influence rooted in clarity, restraint, timing, boundaries, and relational intelligence rather than force, urgency, or domination.
State-Based Override	A decision, communication, purchase, or behavior driven by activation, shutdown, fear, depletion, or appeasement rather than governed choice.
Therapeutic Addendum	A practitioner-facing layer that names safety considerations, clinical boundaries, implementation cautions, and support guidance.
Ventral Regulation	A sufficiently safe, connected, flexible state associated with clearer thinking, steadier communication, and greater recovery access.
Window of Tolerance	The range of activation within which a person can stay present, flexible, and able to respond without moving into overwhelm or shutdown.

Implementation Note: Use these terms consistently across portal copy, downloadable PDFs, practitioner notes, licensing documents, and dashboard labels.